

c. 1922

The following is a faithful transcription of printed article, written by the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey and printed in the "Irish World" C. 1922 (He signed his name on the newsprint copy)

DISTINGUISHED MISSIONARY PRIEST DISCUSSES IRISH AMERICAN SITUATION
(Editor's Headline)

Editor, The Irish World:

Rather than find bitterness in the Irish World concerning the folder recently sent out purporting to be a "statement by Right Rev. Michael J. Gallagher, D.D. dealing with the visit to the United States of Hon. Eamon DeValera," a copy which I have been assured duly reached your office, I want to congratulate you on the dignified silence (or prudent oversight) which in this case especially becomes your long experience and your really responsible position.

I do not like to believe that said statement "is really and expression, carefully considered, of a Bishop whom in more than one way I have admired, and who undoubtedly loves Ireland and justice. Possibly, however, he has been beguiled and I deceive myself, as it seems now that I die deceive myself about 10 months ago when speaking about Cohalan's unfortunate break with DeValera, then recently made manifest, I asked you, "let us hope that his motives are not so unworthy." Perhaps a little time and honest criticism of the "statement will bring out other views and other expressions from Bishop Gallagher. For my part, I cannot think of going into details about it at this time, being as you know only a simple religious and therefore, not experienced in and not inclined to analyse such documents.

This much, however, I will say in its favor: If "differences arise between honest lovers of a common cause mostly because of misunderstandings," then, whatever the motive for publishing the personal correspondence as therein given between DeValera and his opponents, the author has wittingly or unwittingly taken a positive step in the direction of settling differences between Ireland, in her representative, and those in America who honestly oppose the same representative, De Valera.

Personally, at least, if I had never followed up the Irish question at all, as I certainly have been and am, I would be inclined to ask, on reading DeValera's message and the reply it occasioned - to say nothing of the two pages signed "J. D." --I would be more than inclined to ask: "Is this the Friendship that joins the F.O.I.F. and martyred Ireland? Does not DeValera's sentence after sentence show at once a disappointed confidence and a depressed hope as well as a determination forced almost to desperation?" --which determination opponents of Ireland seem to mistake for unbending pride: though even the bitterest of